Corn Chowder (or Corn and Crab)

Soups | Instant Pot

Before you start

Equipment: Instant Pot. Pressure cook: 6 minutes on high, then quick-release. Allow extra time for the pot to reach pressure.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Aromatics

Bowl B - Seasonings

Bowl C - Cornstarch slurry

Bowl D - Corn and sugar

- [ ] 2 slices bacon (or about 2 Tbsp butter if omitting bacon)
- [ ] 1 large onion, diced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 3/4 cup diced carrots [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup diced celery [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup diced red bell pepper [Bowl A]
- [ ] 4 cups chicken broth
- [ ] 1 lb potatoes, diced
- [ ] 1/2 tsp chopped fresh thyme [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1 tsp salt [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 tsp black pepper [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2-2 tsp hot sauce
- [ ] 3 cups corn [Bowl D]

- [ ] 1 tsp sugar [Bowl D]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp cornstarch [Bowl C]
- [ ] 3 Tbsp water [Bowl C]
- [ ] Cooked crab meat, optional, to taste
- [ ] 1/4-1 cup heavy cream

1. Sauté the bacon and vegetables

1. Set the Instant Pot to sauté. Cook 2 slices bacon until nearly crisp. If omitting bacon, use about 2 Tbsp butter instead.

2. Add 1 diced large onion, 3/4 cup diced carrots, 1/2 cup diced celery, and 1/2 cup diced red bell pepper. Sauté 2-3 minutes.

2. Pressure-cook

1. Cancel sauté. Pour in 4 cups chicken broth and thoroughly scrape the bottom to loosen any stuck bits.

2. Add 1 lb diced potatoes, 1/2 tsp chopped fresh thyme, 1 tsp salt, 1/2 tsp black pepper, and 1/2-2 tsp hot sauce.

3. Seal and cook on high pressure for 6 minutes. Quick-release the pressure.

3. Thicken and finish

1. Switch to sauté. Add 3 cups corn and 1 tsp sugar; simmer 1-2 minutes. Mash some potatoes in the pot to thicken the chowder.

2. For additional thickness, mix 2 Tbsp cornstarch with 3 Tbsp water. Stir in only as much of this slurry as needed.

3. If using cooked crab meat, add it to taste and heat through. Turn off the heat, then stir in 1/4-1 cup heavy cream to taste. Adjust seasoning and serve.